the first half of the twentieth century the public schools often assigned textbooks that disparaged Jews. During the 1930s and 1940s, many public and parochial school teachers and some principals and school officials in major U.S. cities like New York, Boston, and Philadelphia belonged to or sympathized with the virulently antisemitic Christian Front, which focused on the deicide charge. In 1946, the mayor of New York even appointed a supporter of the Christian Front to the Board of Education.[3] During World War II, the U.S. military distributed copies of the Protestant and Catholic versions of the New Testament containing such headings as "The Jews Conspire Against Christ," along with numerous footnotes reminding readers that the Jews were deicides.[4]

Often subjected to antisemitic discrimination and harassment, many American Jews, particularly during the first half of the twentieth century, developed profound feelings of self-hatred, internalizing negative Christian stereotypes of Jews. Jewish self-hatred was an important factor in many Jews' "conversion" to Communism or other far left ideologies that repeatedly denigrated Judaism. Jews drawn to the far left during the 1930s and 1940s were largely second-generation Americans, many of whom sought to distance themselves from immigrant parents who were confined to low-status occupations and spoke heavily accented English. A large proportion of the parents were small shopkeepers or peddlers, members of the petty bourgeoisie—a social class Marxists disdained as parasitical and archaic. "Petty bourgeois" was one of the most vicious epithets in the Marxist lexicon. Public school curricula devoted almost no attention to the persecution of Jews or to Jewish culture or contributions to America, even in the 1960s when most New Leftists were in school.[5]

Jewish self-hatred among 1960s radicals and far leftists of succeeding generations, who were, by contrast, mostly of upper middle class background, was largely rooted in guilt about what they considered their privileged backgrounds, and their romanticizing of Third World peoples, whom they viewed as the leading force for revolutionary change. These far leftists admired and were strongly influenced by black nationalists who demonized Jews—the whites most committed to the civil rights struggle—in a determined effort to prove that whites could not be trustworthy allies. Many black nationalists racialized the Christian deicide charge, falsely accusing Jews of controlling the African slave trade, characterized as the attempted genocide of blacks, which only a people guilty of deicide could commit.[6] Ignoring the long history of Arab enslavement of, and contempt for, sub-Saharan Africans, black nationalists cast Arabs as part of the Third World,

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